

Marking Criteria for GY457 Exam Paper

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General marking criteria
- Focus on the question/assignment within time limits
- Critical understanding and evaluation
- Argument or discussion in context of literature
- Independent thought or analysis in argument
- Structure and flow of argument or analysis
- Appropriate citation
- Effective communication

Exam structure and helpful tips
- 4 Questions in total, need to answer 2 questions, one from each part . Time allowed = 3h.
- 2 Questions from Part 1 (AT) – covering lectures, seminars & readings
- 2 questions from Part 2 (WT) – covering lectures, seminars & readings
- Each part contains • one ‘open (essay style) question’ and • one ‘partitioned question’ We will review both types of questions and how to answer them during GY457 Seminar 5 (Week 9 of WT) and also during the Revision Session (W11)
- Answers to ‘open (essay style) questions’ should be well structured , comprehensive (cover all relevant aspects relating to the question, but nothing else) and contain an introduction, main body (analysis) and a concluding part/synthesis.
- Answers to ‘partitioned questions’ should be “straight to the point”. There is no need for an introduction or conclusion for each sub-question.
- Some important remarks: 1) Answers should always be focused on what the question asks and nothing else! 2) Write whole sentences if you can rather than just bullet points. 3) But: If you run out of time, bullet points are fine. 4) Related: It is crucial that you answer all questions and sub-questions. Even if you struggle with the question and you don’t know the answer, try to write something. Say a sub-question awards 30 marks. If you don’t write anything (empty space) even the most sympathetic marker cannot award any marks. If there is some relevant response, even if it is not properly answering the question, the marker can award some points. Say the marker thinks the answer is poor and provides a bad fail mark of say 40% *30 marks = 12 marks. Say you achieved a marginal Distinction mark in the rest of the paper (70% on the remaining 70% of the paper = 49 marks. Without the 12 marks, the question will be marked as a Fail since 49 marks<50 marks! With the 12 marks, the question will get a much more respectable 61 marks, a Merit!

Grade Descriptions			
D 90-100	Authoritative understanding; near-comprehensive knowledge of relevant debates; significant originality and independent thought in interpretation or analysis; coherent structure (may show significant innovation in its organisational form); intensive, detailed and critical use of literature with independent reading beyond reading lists; incisive and fluent style; high levels of ability in analysis of information (where appropriate).	90-100	As good as could be expected under examination conditions
D 80-89	Thorough understanding; detailed knowledge of relevant debates; ample originality and independent thought in interpretation or analysis; coherent structure (may show some innovation in organisational form); in-depth reading (with either independent reading beyond reading lists or intensive, detailed and critical reading of suggested material); incisive and fluent style; high levels of ability in the analysis of quantitative or qualitative information (where appropriate).	85-89	Outstanding performance in all aspects
		80-84	Excellence in most aspects
D 70-79	Thorough understanding; detailed knowledge of relevant debates; some originality and independent thought in interpretation or analysis; coherent structure (may show some innovation in organisational form); good reading (with either independent reading beyond reading lists or intensive, detailed and critical reading of suggested material); incisive and fluent style; high levels of ability in the analysis of quantitative or qualitative information (where appropriate).	75-79	Excellence in most aspects
		70-74	Excellence in some aspects, particularly non-presentation categories
M 60-69	Good understanding; wide-ranging knowledge of relevant debates; direct focus on question; sufficient evidence of independent and critical thought; coherent structure; in-depth reading; fluent style; generally effective analysis of quantitative or qualitative information (where appropriate).	67-69	A good performance in most aspects
		63-66	A good performance in some aspects, particularly non-presentation categories
		60-62	Sufficient quality in aspects 1-4 to show good understanding

P 50-59	Sound understanding and knowledge, with a focus on the question, but is mainly descriptive with insufficient critical insight for a Merit; may draw heavily on lectures or other direct teaching; may be some further reading and referencing but its use is descriptive rather than critical and is likely to be focused on case study descriptions with limited awareness of wider debates; adequate structure; straightforward style; familiarity with correct strategies for analysis of quantitative or qualitative information, but possibly with errors in the process of analysis (where appropriate).	57-59	A good attempt but insufficient critical analysis for a Merit
		53-56	Usually a sound performance in most aspects
		50-52	Despite weaknesses, sufficient evidence for a Pass standard within non-presentation categories
F 40-49	Incomplete understanding of the question for the level; insufficient focus on the question (there may be sections with no relevance to the question); there could be evidence of further reading but the student has completely misunderstood the question; there may be brief signs of understanding and some basic knowledge but likely to contain errors; weak in detail; Limited sense of logical argument.	45-49	Non-presentation categories not addressed to a satisfactory level. Some elements in other aspects may be ok
		40-44	Non-presentation categories not addressed to a satisfactory level
BF 0-39	Work is unacceptable for the level. May be some vague knowledge of subject but likely to be irrelevant or confused. The examiner will have to search for material that is relevant to the question. Work may be unacceptably short. Usually poorly written and badly presented	20-39	No aspects addressed to any satisfactory level
		10-19	Very poor performance in most aspects. May have inadequate structure; or work is too short
		1-9	Likely to be an incomplete piece of work